ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** he saw wit and calm used instead of weapons	Experience corrected his romantic image.
2	**(d)** danger can be ended in an instant by wit	Quick resolution.
3	**(b)** the reader sees the lie while Max does not	The audience knows more than Max.
4	**(d)** believed it under pressure	Fear and haste made him accept it.
5	**(c)** ability to think and act quickly in danger	Quick thinking.
6	**(b)** Ausable said that there was a balcony outside.	Backshift.
7	**(c)** his calm voice despite the gun	Calmness shows control.
8	**(d)** Max falls from the window	The lie causes Max's jump.
9	**(b)** inventive	Clever and original.
10	**(a)** convinced Max that the police were coming	It added pressure.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	To contrast his appearance with his ability (1) and to surprise the reader by his clever action (1).	1+1
12	He narrates the events (1) and his innocence lets the reader share the surprise (1).	1+1
13	In fiction spies are glamorous (1) but in reality they depend on brains and cool nerves (1).	1+1
14	He invents a believable story about a balcony (1) and Max, trusting his words, acts on them and falls (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Ausable looks heavy and ordinary but acts with great skill. The contrast between look and ability makes him memorable. It surprises both Fowler and the reader.	1+1+1
16	He begins as an eager young writer with a romantic idea of spies. He is disappointed by Ausable's looks. By the end he admires his wit and understands real intelligence.	1+1+1
17	Fowler visited Ausable because he wanted a story. Both are simple past.	1+1+1
	OR: The lie is the turning point. It leads Max to jump and ends the danger. It also displays Ausable's cleverness and shows how words can be a weapon.	1+1+1
18	He is armed and determined, and he enters at night. He frightens Fowler and threatens Ausable. His panic at the knock shows he is also fearful.	1+1+1
	OR: Max ordered him to give him the papers or he would shoot. The command and the threat are reported with 'ordered' and 'would'.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Max has weapon and strength (1). Ausable has calm and wit (1). The balcony lie traps Max (1). Max defeats himself (1). Conclusion: intelligence wins (1).	2+2+1
	OR: It adds to Max's alarm (1). It suggests the police (1). It pushes him to the window (1). Timing completes the trick (1). It is a turning point (1).	2+2+1
20	Max is a rival agent, armed and ruthless (1). He breaks in at midnight (1). He is greedy for the papers (1). He is quick to panic (1). He falls for Ausable's lie (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Ausable is relaxed and cheerful (1). Max is tense and violent (1). Calm brings clear thinking (1). Panic causes error (1). Result: Ausable wins (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Ausable a tall, handsome secret agent; he is a **fat, ordinary-looking** man, unlike the spies Fowler imagined from books.
- Writing that the visitor Max came through the front door; he is a spy who enters the room **unseen at midnight**, and holds Ausable and Fowler at gunpoint.

- Mixing up the trick: Ausable bluffs that police are at the door, and Max jumps through the window to a 'balcony' that **does not exist**.
- Calling Fowler the hero; he is a young writer of *romantic spy tales* who learns that real adventure is different.
- Forgetting that the 'police' were only a **waiter** with a drink, which Ausable had expected from **Henry**.
- Spelling slips: *Ausable, Fowler, espionage, balcony, thriller*; and mixed tenses when summarising the plot.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Ausable's attitude	Ausable stayed calm.
2	**(c)** fast with a sudden twist	A short thriller.
3	**(c)** ingenious	Clever and inventive.
4	**(c)** Ausable tricked Max.	Subject performs the action.
5	**(a)** Why did Max trust Ausable's story?	Requires reasoning.
6	**(c)** There was no balcony outside the window.	The balcony was a lie.
7	**(b)** could	Past possibility.
8	**(d)** his earlier idea of spying has been overturned	The twist surprised him.
9	**(d)** it is often exaggerated	Real spying is quieter.
10	**(b)** He had faced danger before	His calm shows experience.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Ausable keeps cool though threatened (1) and so is able to think of a plan (1).	1+1
12	He was in a hurry and afraid of arrest (1) and the idea of a balcony beneath a high window seemed plausible (1).	1+1
13	It makes Max believe the police have come (1) and it forces him to act without thinking (1).	1+1
14	A plain and unarmed man defeats a dangerous armed agent (1) and the 'escape route' becomes the cause of Max's fall (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Short and sharp lines between Max and Ausable show threat and calm. Ausable's easy tone contrasts with Max's menace. The dialogue moves the plot towards the trick.	1+1+1
16	The reader expects a fight or an escape. Instead Ausable's trick makes Max jump to his end. The sudden twist is the surprise.	1+1+1
17	It has danger, a villain with a gun and rising suspense. A quick twist ends it. These are features of a thriller.	1+1+1
	OR: Ausable seems to have thought of the trick in advance or invents it very fast. His mind was ready for danger. The story shows that preparation helps in crisis.	1+1+1
18	Ausable's calm jokes in danger add light humour. The ordinary-looking agent surprises the young writer. Humour relieves tension but increases our liking of him.	1+1+1
	OR: Max's fear of the police causes his jump. Fowler fears the gun. Ausable alone controls fear, and so wins.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Expectation: dashing, mysterious hero (1). Reality: plain, plump, cheerful man (1). Real danger uses wit (1). Fowler learns (1). Contrast adds irony (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Fowler's curiosity (1). Ausable's modest reply (1). Explanation of reading Max's fear (1). A light closing joke (1).	2+2+1
20	Suspense: the gun and the midnight setting (1). Rising tension with the knock (1). Surprise: the false balcony (1). The sudden jump (1). Together they thrill the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opinion (1). The visitor is Max (1). The time is midnight (1). The title builds suspense (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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- Mixing up the trick: Ausable bluffs that police are at the door, and Max jumps through the window to a 'balcony' that **does not exist**.

- Calling Fowler the hero; he is a young writer of *romantic spy tales* who learns that real adventure is different.
- Forgetting that the 'police' were only a **waiter** with a drink, which Ausable had expected from **Henry**.
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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** the threatened Ausable defeats Max	Roles reversed.
2	**(a)** Max had broken in before Ausable spoke.	Past perfect.
3	**(d)** it offers plot, danger and a clever twist	Material for a spy tale.
4	**(a)** Ausable looked ordinary, yet he was brave.	'Yet' contrasts.
5	**(b)** ruthless	He was threatening.
6	**(a)** casual and confident	He sounds easy.
7	**(b)** adverb	Modifies the verb.
8	**(c)** he sees events with fresh, innocent eyes	His naivety adds surprise.
9	**(d)** an invited guest	An invited guest is welcome.
10	**(a)** A Clever Lie at Midnight	Reflects the plot.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The danger of the gun looms until the last moment (1) and the trick is revealed only when Max jumps (1).	1+1
12	Escape is hard and the drop is great (1) so the lie of the balcony becomes the only believable way out for Max (1).	1+1
13	He does not fight but thinks (1) and faces danger with calm humour (1).	1+1
14	His presence of mind (1) and his cheerful courage in danger (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The story is narrated by Fowler in the first person. He is not part of the secret world and so sees it with wonder. Thus the reader shares his surprise at the twist.	1+1+1
16	(a) Max was tricked by Ausable. (b) The gun was taken by Max.	1+1+1
17	Ausable reads Max's mind and uses his fear. He knows Max will act on a lie under pressure. Understanding people is a powerful skill.	1+1+1
	OR: It highlights the sudden arrival of Max at night. It creates mystery and suspense. It focuses on the visit that brings the central danger.	1+1+1
18	Ausable, who is an agent, lives in a Paris hotel. Or: Ausable is an agent who lives in a Paris hotel.	1+1+1
	OR: The story stops soon after Max's jump. This leaves a sharp impression of the trick. The shortness of the ending gives the story force.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Ausable's example (1). Explanation of how it helps (1). Everyday examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Keep calm in danger (1). Think before acting (1). Use wit rather than force (1). Do not judge people by looks (1). Stay confident (1).	2+2+1
20	Headline (1). Place and time (1). What the witness saw (1). Statement by the hotel (1). Closing note (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address, date (1). Salutation (1). Short summary (1). Why it is gripping (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

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